MARKET INTELLIGENCE BRIEFING

TrustMRR 1000 Row Dataset

Growth Benchmarks, Category Economics & M&A Opportunity
Across 1,000 Live, Revenue-Verified SaaS Businesses

TrustMRR 1,000-Row Dataset · **Frozen July 30, 2026**

Prepared for VC Investors · Corporate M&A Leaders · SaaS Founders

$13.5M	$133.8M	1,000	26.2%
ECOSYSTEM MRR	12-MONTH REVENUE	STARTUPS TRACKED	LISTED FOR SALE

01 · MACRO VIEW

The Ecosystem at a Glance

N = 1,000 revenue-verified startups · TrustMRR dataset, frozen July 30, 2026

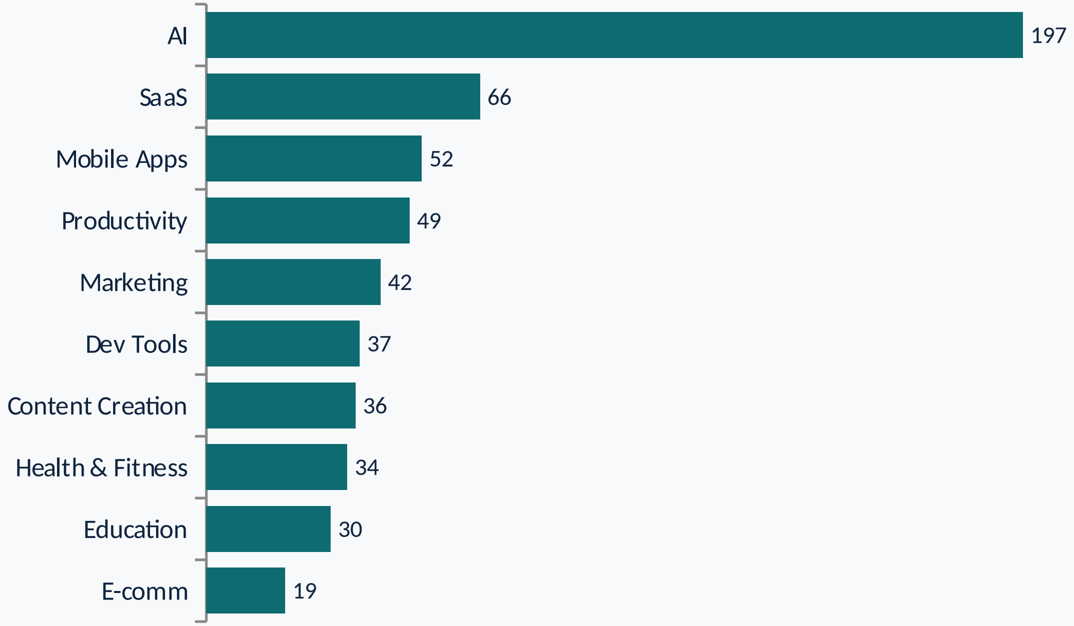
$13.5M
TOTAL ECOSYSTEM MRR

$133.8M
TRAILING 12-MONTH REVENUE

$334.0M
ALL-TIME CUMULATIVE REVENUE

26.2%
STARTUPS LISTED FOR SALE

Top Categories by Startup Count



WHY THE MEAN LIES

Median MRR is just $282
...but the mean is $13.5K — a 48x gap.

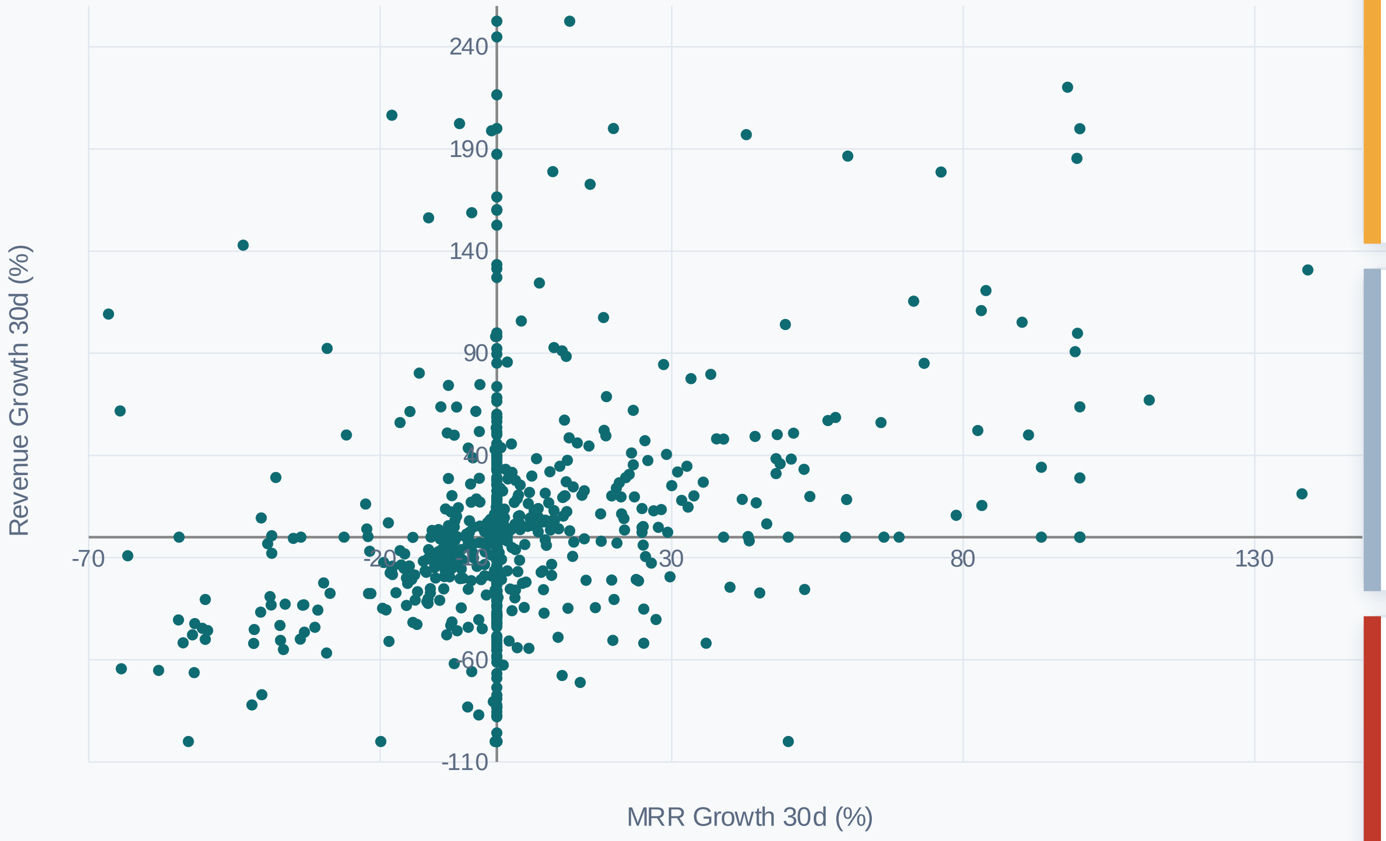
This is a classic power-law market: a small number of breakout companies carry the bulk of ecosystem revenue while the typical listing is still a micro-business.

Category tagging covers 726 of 1,000 startups (72.6%); country of origin is known for 759 (75.9%) — treat uncategorized rows as a distinct "unlabeled" segment, not zero.

Momentum Is Not Evenly Distributed

Segmented on 30-day MRR growth · 893 of 1,000 startups report growth data

30-Day MRR Growth vs. 30-Day Revenue Growth · every tracked startup (n=893)



Each point = one startup. Segment thresholds (right) applied on 30-day MRR growth.

High-Growth

173

≥ +10%/mo

19.4% of tracked

Median MRR $1.0K Median growth +37.7%

Median active subs 30 · Median DR 11.5

Top: AI, Marketing, Dev Tools

Stable

550

-5% to +10%/mo

61.6% of tracked

Median MRR $173 Median growth +0.0%

Median active subs 10 · Median DR 12

Top: AI, Mobile Apps, SaaS

Declining

170

≤ -5%/mo

19.0% of tracked

Median MRR $1.4K Median growth -14.8%

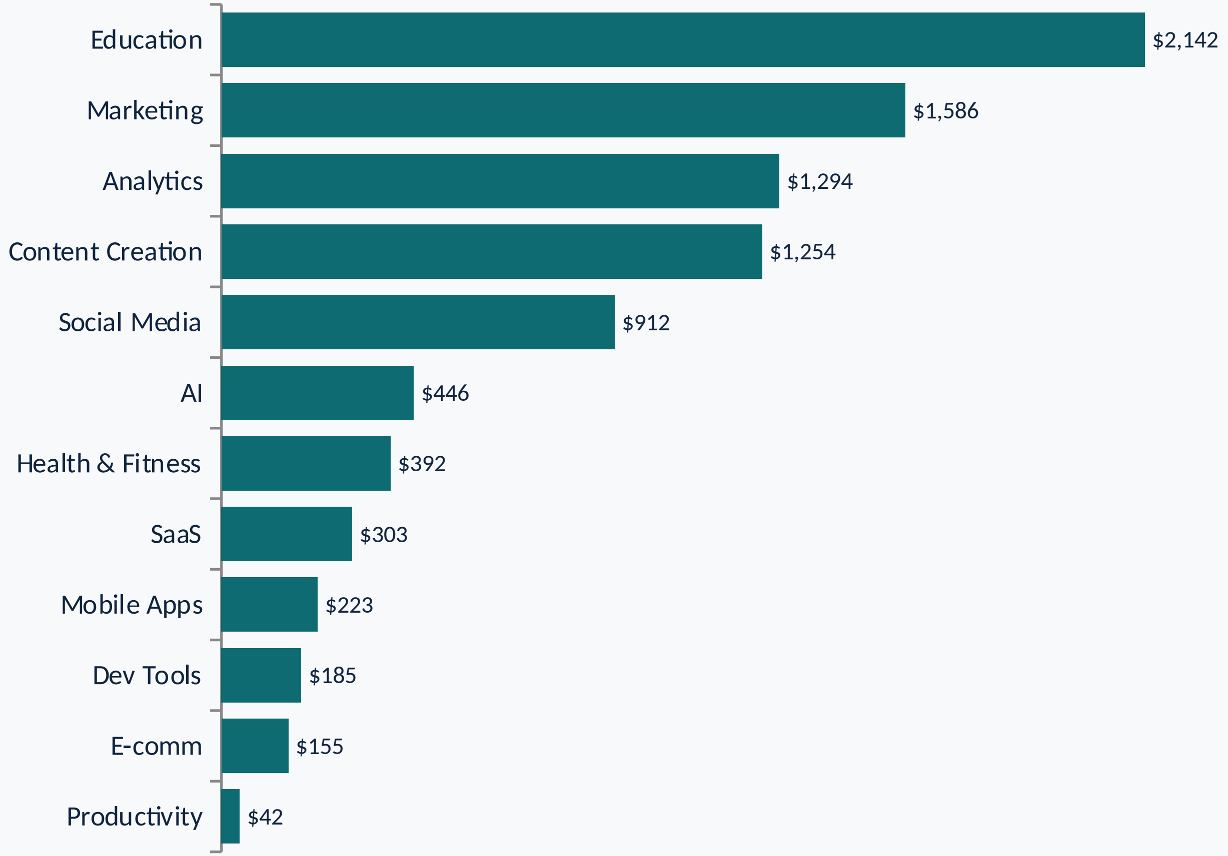
Median active subs 36 · Median DR 15

Top: AI, SaaS, Content Creation

Which Types of Businesses Make the Most Money?

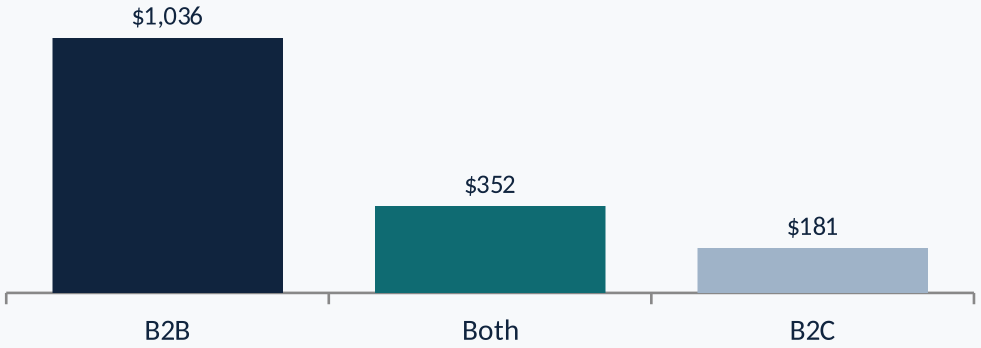
Based on 726 startups with a listed industry. "MRR" just means the steady monthly income a company collects from its paying customers.

Typical Monthly Income, by Industry



Only industries with at least 18 companies are shown, so the numbers are reliable.

Who Pays More: Businesses or Everyday Customers?



B2B = sells to other businesses · B2C = sells to everyday people · Both = sells to both

WHY THIS MATTERS

5.7x

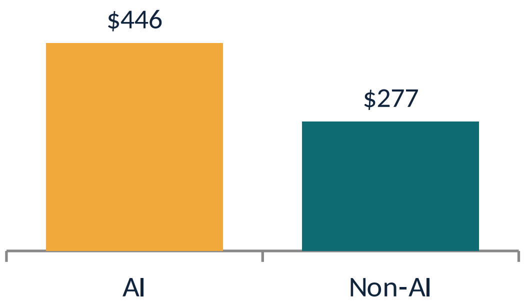
Companies that sell to other businesses (B2B) typically bring in $1,036 a month — nearly 6x more than the $181 typical for companies selling to everyday customers (B2C). Both have a similar number of paying customers (16 vs. 19) — B2B companies simply charge more per customer.

Education and Marketing earn the most per company ($2,142 and $1,586/month). AI is the most common industry (197 companies) but sits in the middle for income ($446/month).

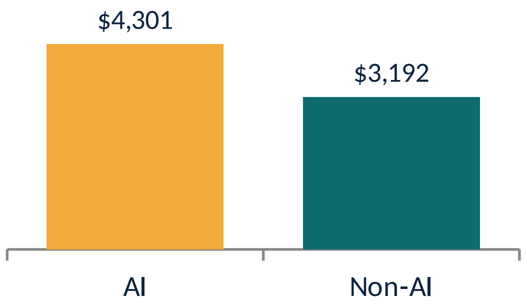
AI Commands a Revenue Premium — Not (Yet) a Growth One

AI-tagged startups (n=197) vs. non-AI, category-known startups (n=529)

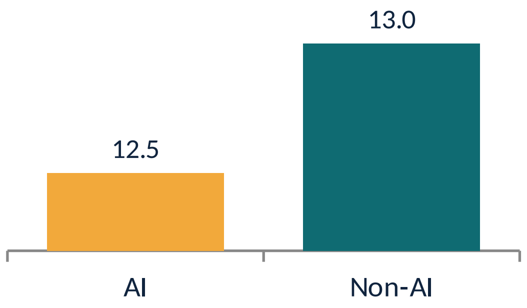
MEDIAN MRR



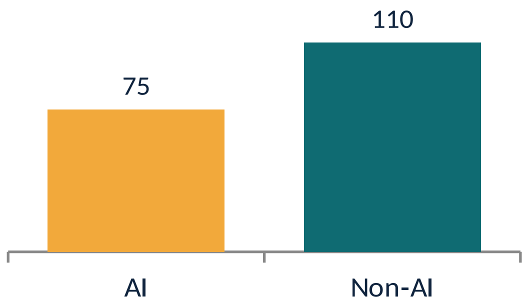
MEDIAN 12-MO REVENUE



MEDIAN DOMAIN RATING



MEDIAN X FOLLOWERS



READ-THROUGH

AI startups earn 61% more median MRR and 35% more 12-month revenue than non-AI peers — the "AI premium" is real on monetization.

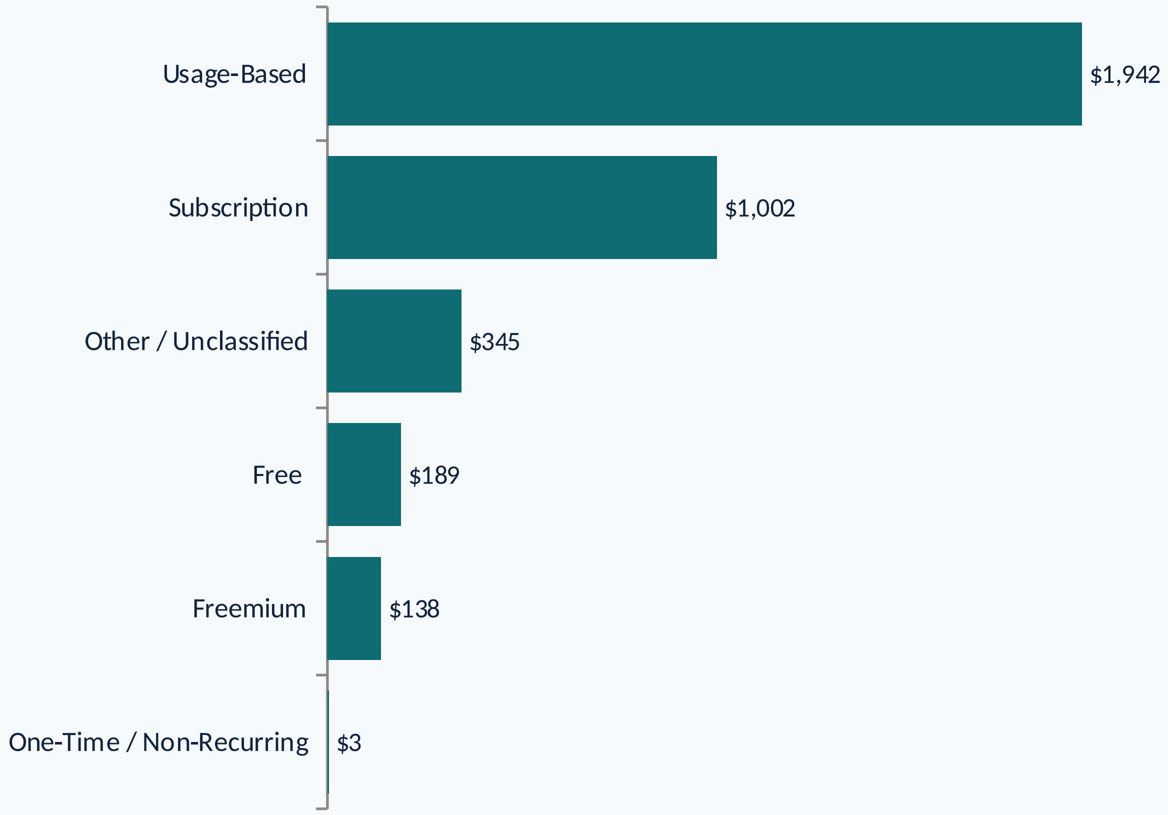
Median 30-day MRR growth is flat (0.0%) for both cohorts — AI's edge is in revenue captured per company, not in outrunning traditional SaaS on momentum.

AI startups carry fewer X followers (75 vs. 110) and near-identical Domain Rating — AI growth today looks product-led, not audience-led.

Recurring Pricing Out-Earns Free — By 5.3x

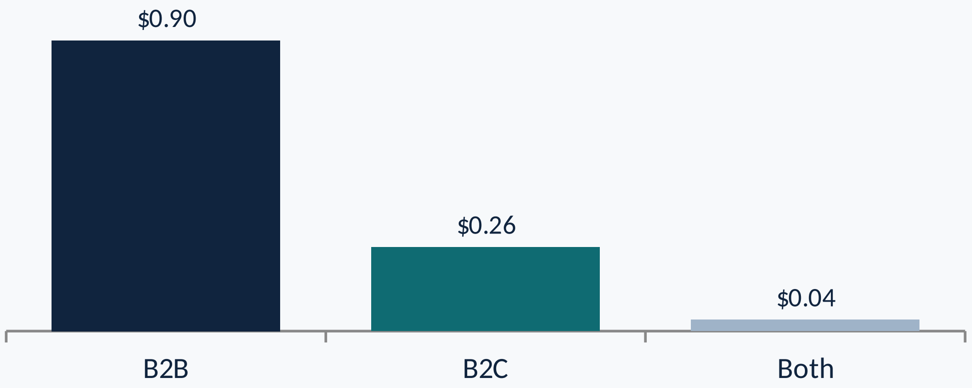
Pricing model documented for 657 of 1,000 startups · classified into 6 mutually exclusive billing structures

Median MRR by Pricing Model



Bucket sizes: Subscription n=234 · Freemium+Sub n=218 · Free n=105 · Other n=43 · Usage-Based n=36 · One-Time/Non-Recurring n=21

Revenue per Visitor, by Audience



TRAFFIC MONETIZATION GAP

3.5x

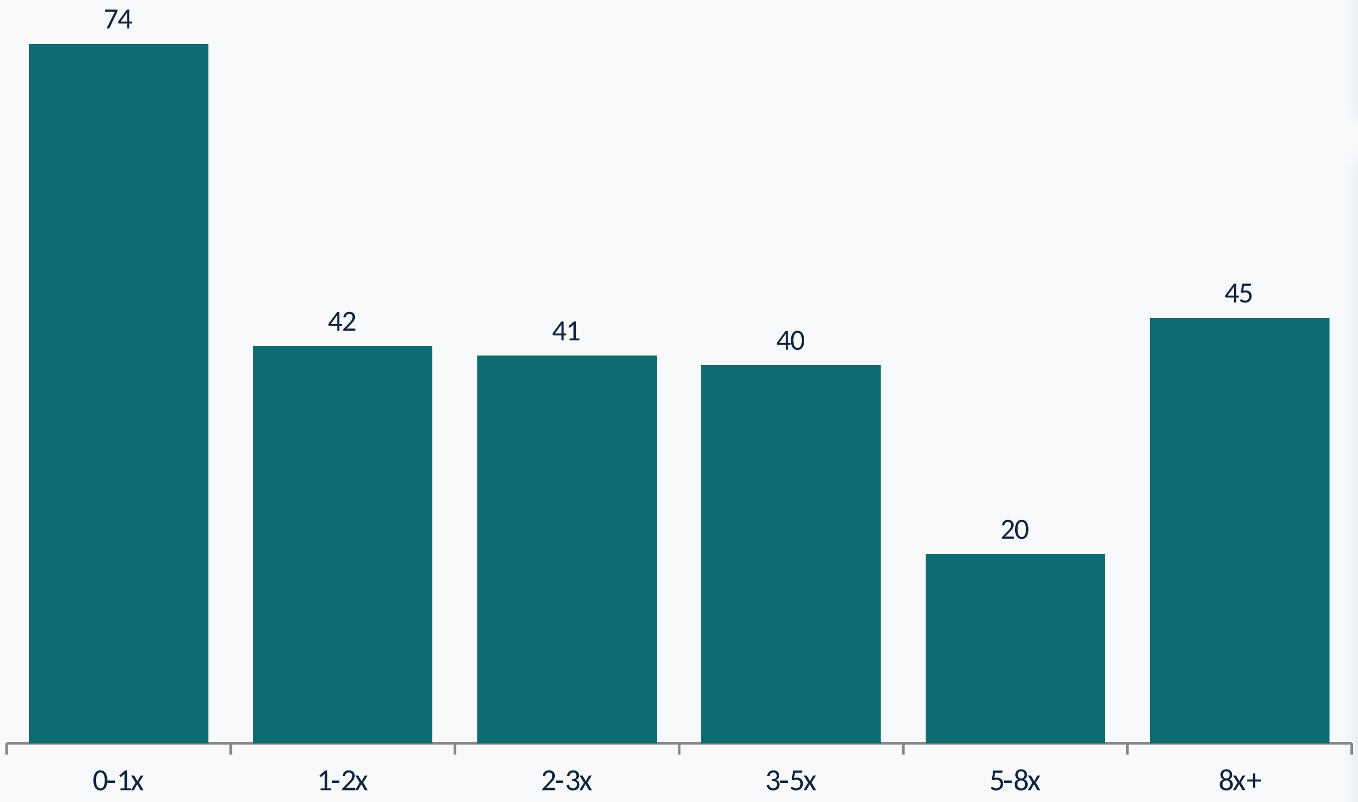
B2B converts visitor traffic into revenue far more efficiently than B2C ($0.90 vs. $0.26 per visitor).

Usage-based pricing posts the richest median MRR ($1,942, n=36); one-time/non-recurring pricing the weakest ($2.99, n=21) — recurring billing is the reliable lever.

1 in 4 Startups Is For Sale — Most Priced Under 3x

262 of 1,000 startups (26.2%) are listed on_sale with a disclosed revenue multiple

Revenue-Multiple Distribution of Listed Startups



Median multiple 2.3x · mean 7.8x, pulled up by 5 outlier listings priced 100x-327x ("8x+" bucket includes all of them)

$35.0K
MEDIAN ASKING PRICE

2.3x
MEDIAN REVENUE MULTIPLE

THE SCARCE TARGET

29

startups combine High-Growth momentum (≥+10% MRR/mo) with an active for-sale listing — just 11% of the M&A pool.

Their median asking multiple is only 2.2x — near the market median — despite superior momentum.

Growth vs. multiple correlation: r=0.36 (n=248) — momentum is only partly priced in, leaving room for disciplined buyers.

Base-Case Forecast: +64% Ecosystem MRR by Month 12

Bottom-up model: each growth cohort's current run-rate, decayed toward the mean as momentum matures

Projected Total Ecosystem MRR — Base Case ($M)

Cohort composition today: Stable $8.4M (62%) · High-Growth $2.6M (19%) · Declining $2.1M (16%)

+18.5%

PROJECTED MRR GROWTH, 3 MONTHS

MOMENTUM CEILING

+64.1%

base-case ecosystem MRR growth over 12 months, assuming High-Growth and Declining cohort rates decay toward the mean (halving every ~3 months) rather than persisting flat.

If current monthly rates held undecayed, the mechanical extrapolation exceeds +800% by month 12 — a mathematical ceiling, not a realistic forecast. It signals how much of ecosystem growth rides on a small High-Growth cohort sustaining momentum, not a literal target.

The Playbook: Founders, Buyers, Investors

Levers implied directly by the cohort, category, and M&A patterns above

1 FOUNDERS

- Shift toward recurring subscription or usage-based pricing — median MRR runs 5-14x richer than free or freemium models.
- If B2C, pursue a B2B or "Both" motion where feasible: B2B commands a 5.7x median-MRR premium on a similar subscriber base.
- Track 30-day MRR growth explicitly — the Declining cohort (19% of the market) has higher median MRR than High-Growth, meaning size alone doesn't protect momentum.

2 BUYERS & ACQUIRERS

- 26.2% of the dataset is on-sale at a median 2.3x revenue multiple and $35K asking price — well below typical SaaS strategic multiples.
- Target the 29 High-Growth-and-for-sale listings: they still clear at a 2.2x median multiple despite superior momentum.
- AI and Mobile Apps dominate the for-sale pool by count (54 and 29 listings) — the deepest sourcing lanes for category-focused roll-ups.

3 INVESTORS & VCs

- Growth and revenue multiple correlate at only r=0.36 — momentum is under-priced in this market, favoring diligence-driven sourcing over headline multiples.
- AI carries a monetization premium (+61% median MRR) without a matching growth premium yet — underwrite on unit economics, not category label.
- Base-case modeling implies +64% ecosystem MRR over 12 months if today's High-Growth cohort sustains even a decaying pace — concentration risk worth stress-testing per portfolio company.

MARKET INTELLIGENCE BRIEFING

A Power-Law Market, Underpriced on Momentum

1,000 companies · $13.5M in tracked MRR · 26.2% actively for sale at a median 2.3x multiple.
The data favors operators who fix monetization and buyers who move on growth before the market re-prices it.

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-Row Dataset, frozen July 30, 2026

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